

April

6

1896

Modern Olympics

King George I of Greece and 60,000 spectators welcomed athletes from 13 countries as they prepared to compete in the first modern Olympics in Athens, 1,500 years after the Olympic Games were banned by Roman emperor Theodosius I.



Born this day

1483 Raphael, Italian painter and architect. Among his most important masterpieces are the paintings now hanging in the Raphael Rooms, a suite of apartments at the Vatican.

Axe the tax

Catherine the Great of Russia abolished a hugely unpopular tax on beards that had been in place for more than 70 years. The day is now celebrated in Russia as Beard Day.

1772



Winner takes it all

Swedish pop group ABBA won the Eurovision Song Contest with their catchy song *Waterloo*, catapulting them to global stardom.

1974

Also on this day

1909 US explorer Robert Peary claimed to have discovered the North Pole, but decades later an investigation cast doubts on this achievement.

1917 The USA entered World War I, declaring war against Germany after German attacks sank US merchant ships and claimed civilian lives.

1943 The classic children's tale *Le Petit Prince* (*The Little Prince*) by Antoine de Saint-Exupéry was first published in the USA.

